



Beyond Dead Zones: THE ROLE OF SATELLITES In Modern Smartphone Connectivity

The impact of satellites on smartphone connectivity is set to eliminate dead zones, fundamentally changing the way we communicate and access the internet.

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Satellite-to-cell technology, once limited by high costs, is now gaining traction through startups like AST Mobile and Lynk, aiming to enhance satellite connectivity. This advancement is particularly crucial in areas with sparse cellular infrastructure, where it can be instrumental in emergencies.

The mainstream adoption of satellite connectivity in smartphones is imminent, with Android 14 compatibility and speculation about other major manufacturers following suit. This shift is supported by the 3GPP's Release 17 standards, which recognise satellites as a complementary technology to cellular communication. This recognition paves the way for emergency text messaging and potentially broadband communications.

The rise of satellite-to-cell technology

The integration of satellite connectivity in smartphones, led by companies like Huawei and Apple, marks a significant shift in mobile technology. This feature enables devices to send SOS messages via low-orbit satellites in areas lacking cellular signals, offering crucial support in emergencies. As technology evolves, terms such as 'satellite communication' and 'non-terrestrial networks (NTN)' are increasingly prevalent in both consumer and technical conversations.

Direct-to-handset satellite communication is gaining consumer and regulatory attention, with forecasts suggesting over 200 million satellite-compatible